NOES: None (0)

ABSTAINS: None (0)

INFORMATION ITEMS

5. Overview of the 6th Cycle RHNA Methodology

Chair Rhodes noted that the previous month they had heard about the RHNA methodology process, which had been one of the Subcommittee's primary responsibilities to develop. He indicated that, due to time constraints, they had heard a brief overview of milestones and the various components that could be considered. He explained that SCAG staff would continue the overview and also provide an overview of the 6th cycle methodology. He emphasized that understanding the components and allocation formula of the 6th cycle methodology could help inform discussion of the various components that they would ultimately recommend for the 7th cycle methodology.

Ma'Ayn Johnson, Department Manager of Housing, provided an overview of the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology to inform future discussions regarding development of the seventh-cycle methodology. She reviewed the statutory requirements governing RHNA, including housing objectives, planning factors, and consistency with Connect SoCal. Ms. Johnson explained that the sixth-cycle methodology allocated housing need based on a combination of projected housing need and existing housing need, with existing need determined through factors such as job accessibility, transit accessibility, and regional equity considerations. She further described how social equity adjustments had been applied to promote fair housing objectives, avoid the overconcentration of lower-income households, and distribute housing need across income categories. She noted that staff had continued to work with the California Department of Housing and Community Development on the regional determination and had remained on schedule to present a proposed seventh-cycle methodology to the Subcommittee in March 2027.

Jim Light commented that the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology had resulted in inequitable housing allocations for certain jurisdictions. He cited the City of Redondo Beach as an example, noting that factors such as job accessibility and transit proximity did not fully reflect local conditions, including transit usage, jobs-to-housing balance, and limited opportunities for commercial-to-residential conversion. He expressed concern that the allocation had contributed to the displacement of jobs and increased commuting and encouraged consideration of these issues during development of the seventh-cycle RHNA methodology.

Regional Council Member Gabbard questioned whether the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology may have disproportionately allocated housing need to communities with high access to jobs and transit, including potentially disadvantaged areas. He acknowledged that the methodology had included